



VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM – REFERENCE DOCUMENT

SkinLabs® Design System

A practical reference for engineers and AI coding assistants working on the SkinLabs codebase — brand logo usage, color tokens (light & dark), typography, the shared brand gradient, shadows, corner radii, and core UI patterns (buttons, badges, cards, dark mode). Every value here is copied directly from the live source files, not re-derived or approximated — see the source index on the final page.

GENERATED

**15 September
2026**

FRAMEWORK

**React 18 + Vite +
Tailwind CSS**

COMPONENT KIT

**shadcn/ui (Radix
primitives)**

REPO

**jobbyist/skinlabs-
africa**

Primary logotype



FILE	src/assets/newskinlabs.png
NATIVE SIZE	804 × 261px, PNG/RGBA
RENDERED HEIGHT	h-8 (32px) mobile · h-9 (36px) desktop, width auto
USED IN	Header.tsx (site nav), imported as logo
FAVICON	public/favicon.ico

The "BETA" pill and "skinlabs®" registered-trademark suffix seen in the header are **not baked into the PNG** — the logo file is the wordmark only. The "BETA" superscript badge is a separate absolutely-positioned `<span>` rendered next to it in `Header.tsx`, and the ® is set in text where the brand name "SkinLabs®" appears in copy. Never flatten these into a new logo asset — keep them as live text/markup so they inherit theme colors correctly in dark mode.

Clearspace & minimum size

No formal clearspace/minimum-size spec exists in the codebase today — the only constraint enforced in code is the two rendered heights above (32px / 36px). If a stricter brand guideline is introduced, document it here and reflect it as a reusable constant rather than a magic number repeated per usage.

Brand name in copy

- **"SkinLabs®"** — full brand name with registered-trademark mark, used in body copy, meta tags and legal/footer text.
- **"SkinLabs"** (no ®) — used in the wordmark image's alt text and casual in-app references.
- **"SKYNN AI"** — the AI skin-analysis product name, always spelled in full capitals, distinct from the SkinLabs brand name itself. Always paired with "(beta)" while in beta.

Product sub-brand: SKYNN AI



SKYNN AI's own wordmark treatment is a white pill, black text, Sparkles icon, with the animated brand-gradient ring border (`.gradient-border-anim`, see page 03) — this is the "flagship AI feature" visual signature used consistently for SKYNN AI mentions across the header, Smart Routines, and the dashboard.

All colors are defined as HSL CSS custom properties in `src/index.css` (never raw hex in components) and consumed through Tailwind's theme mapping in `tailwind.config.ts` — e.g. `bg-primary` resolves to `hsl(var(--primary))`. The base theme is deliberately monochrome/greyscale; color is reserved for the brand gradient (page 03) as an accent, not a background replacement.

Light mode (:root)

--background
hsl(0 0% 99%)
#fcfcfc

--foreground
hsl(0 0% 15%)
#262626

--card
hsl(0 0% 100%)
#ffffff

--popover
hsl(0 0% 100%)
#ffffff

--primary
hsl(0 0% 15%)
#262626

--primary-foreground
hsl(0 0% 100%)
#ffffff

--secondary
hsl(0 0% 96%)
#f5f5f5

--secondary-foreground
hsl(0 0% 20%)
#333333

--muted
hsl(0 0% 96%)
#f5f5f5

--muted-foreground
hsl(0 0% 45%)
#737373

--accent
hsl(0 0% 90%)
#e6e6e6

--accent-foreground
hsl(0 0% 25%)
#404040

--destructive
hsl(0 70% 50%)
#d92626

--destructive-foreground
hsl(0 0% 100%)
#ffffff

--border
hsl(0 0% 85%)
#d9d9d9

--input
hsl(0 0% 85%)
#d9d9d9

--ring
hsl(0 0% 15%)
#262626

Dark mode (.dark)

--background
hsl(0 0% 15%)
#262626

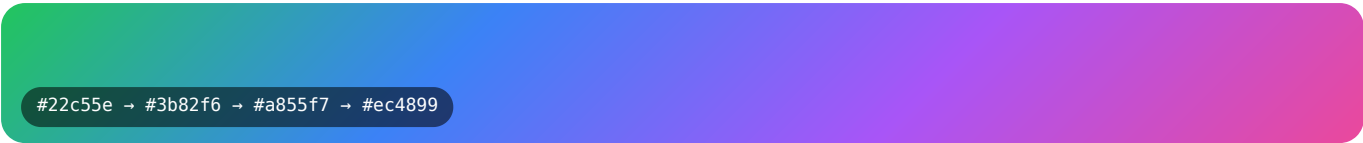
--foreground
hsl(248 0.3% 98.4%)
#fbfbfb

--card
hsl(266 4% 20.8%)
#353337

--popover
hsl(266 4% 20.8%)
#353337

--primary hsl(256 1.3% 92.9%) #ededed	--primary-foreground hsl(266 4% 20.8%) #353337	--secondary hsl(260 4.1% 27.9%) #46444a	--secondary-foreground hsl(248 0.3% 98.4%) #fbfbfb
--muted hsl(260 4.1% 27.9%) #46444a	--muted-foreground hsl(257 4% 70.4%) #b2b1b7	--accent hsl(260 4.1% 27.9%) #46444a	--accent-foreground hsl(248 0.3% 98.4%) #fbfbfb
--destructive hsl(22 19.1% 70.4%) #c2b0a5	--destructive-foreground hsl(248 0.3% 98.4%) #fbfbfb	--border hsl(0 0% 100%) #ffffff	--ring hsl(264 2.7% 55.1%) #8c8990

One reusable 4-stop gradient — **emerald → blue → purple → pink** — is the site's only departure from the monochrome base palette. It's defined once as `--gradient-brand` in `src/index.css` and used sparingly, as a "flagship AI feature" accent (one moment per screen), never as a default text or background color.



STOP	HEX	ROLE
1	#22c55e	emerald-500
2	#3b82f6	blue-500
3	#a855f7	purple-500
4	#ec4899	pink-500

.gradient-text

Smarter care.

Text-clip gradient. Used on SKYNN AI's "Smarter care." headline, the "SKYNN AI" wordmark in nav/badges, and the confidence-score percentage.

.gradient-border-anim



Animated conic-gradient ring (5s spin, disabled under prefers-reduced-motion). Applied to every white-bg/black-text nav button, Explore-grid cards, and the SKYNN AI pill.

Usage index

UTILITY / PATTERN	FILE	WHERE USED
.gradient-text	index.css	SKYNN AI headline & wordmark, ConfidencePanel %, SmartRoutines hero badge
.gradient-border-anim	index.css	Header nav pills (Menu/Search/Account/SKYNN AI), Explore cards, mobile Create account/Sign out, hero eyebrow badge
.gradient-bg-soft	index.css	FloatingBottomNav active-tab tint (low-opacity wash over --accent)
NavBadge	Header.tsx	"NEW"/"BETA" pills → brand gradient; "Coming Soon" → amber→orange gradient (kept semantically distinct)
StepperHeader current-step	ai-formulator/StepperHeader.tsx	Gradient-filled circle instead of a flat primary border
SVG linearGradient	ai-formulator/ConfidencePanel.tsx	Recharts radial completeness ring, id skynn-confidence-gradient
ScrollProgressBar	ScrollProgressBar.tsx	2px bar at the header's bottom edge, width = scroll position

```
.gradient-text {
  background: var(--gradient-brand);
  background-clip: text; -webkit-background-clip: text;
  color: transparent; -webkit-text-fill-color: transparent;
}
```


ROLE	TAILWIND CLASS	FONT STACK	USED FOR
Heading	font-heading	Montserrat	All h1-h4, card/section titles
Body / sans	font-sans (default)	Inter	Paragraphs, UI labels, buttons
Serif	font-serif	Lora	Available but rarely used in current UI
Mono	font-mono	Space Mono	Kbd hints (⌘K), code-like labels

Loaded via Google Fonts <link> in index.html (weights 400/500/600/700, plus 800 for Montserrat) — not self-hosted or via next/font (this is a Vite SPA, not Next.js).

Heading tracking

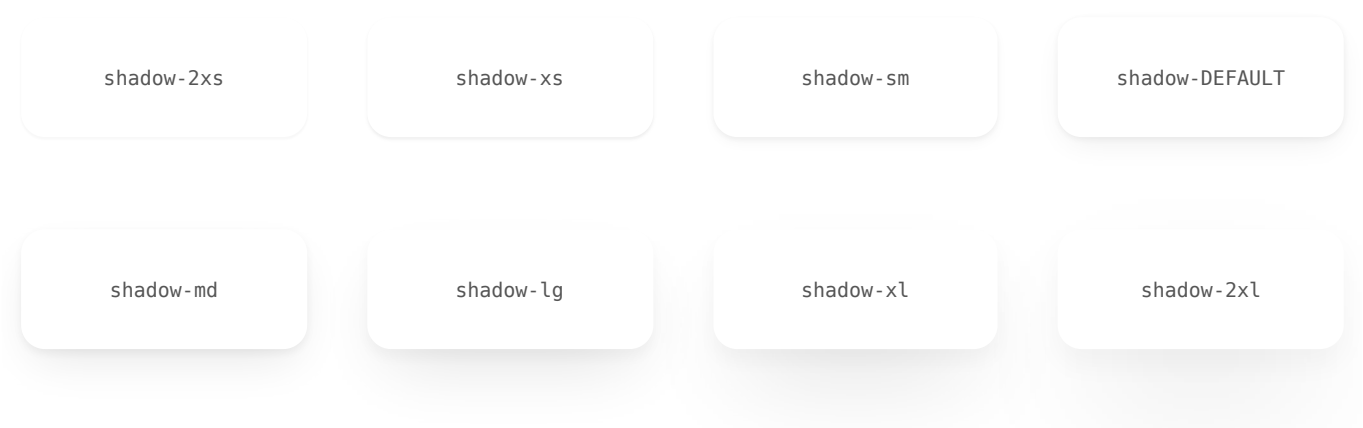
h1-h4 and any element with .font-heading default to letter-spacing: -0.015em via a base-layer rule in index.css. An explicit Tailwind tracking-* utility on a component always wins (Tailwind's utilities layer outranks the base layer regardless of source order).

Type scale (as rendered on the homepage hero / cards)

H1	Skincare, without the nonsense.
H2	What makes Smart Routines different
H3	Your Advanced AI Dermatology Report
Body	We read the ingredient list so you don't have to.
Small / muted	From R25 with Analysis Pass
Mono / kbd	⌘K · Navigate · Select · Esc

Shadow scale — two-layer "contact + ambient" stack

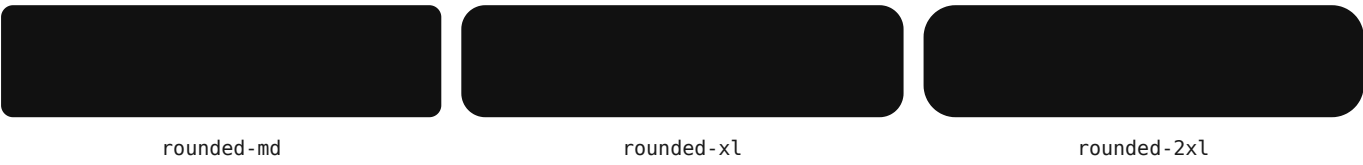
Every shadow-* Tailwind utility resolves to a CSS variable in index.css, each combining a tight, low-opacity "contact" shadow close to the surface with a softer, wider "ambient" shadow further out — never a single hard-edged shadow. Dark mode redefines the same scale at higher opacity for visibility against dark surfaces.



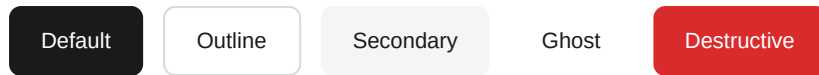
Corner radius

TOKEN	VALUE	USED FOR
rounded-sm	calc(0.5rem - 4px) = 4px	Small inline chips
rounded-md	calc(0.5rem - 2px) = 6px	Button default (ui/button.tsx base)
rounded-lg	0.5rem = 8px (--radius)	Popover / dropdown-menu / select content
rounded-xl	0.75rem = 12px	Dialog & AlertDialog content (sm: and up)
rounded-2xl	1rem = 16px	Card (default), CommandDialog (search) on mobile
rounded-full	9999px	Badge, Avatar, all pill buttons

ui/sheet.tsx (the mobile nav drawer) is deliberately left un-rounded — it's an edge-anchored panel, not a floating modal, and rounding the anchored edge would look wrong.



Buttons (ui/button.tsx)



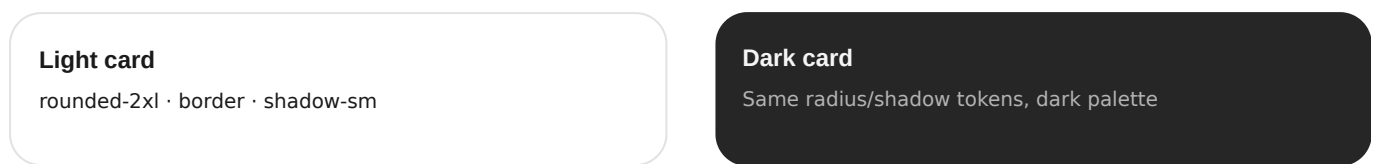
Rule: any button rendering a white background with black text (i.e. `variant="outline"` in light mode) gets `.gradient-border-anim` plus `border-transparent` (to hide the plain grey border underneath — `tailwind-merge` resolves the class conflict cleanly). Black-bg/white-text buttons (`variant="default"`) are left plain.

Badges



Component: `NavBadge` in `Header.tsx`. Amber→orange is kept visually distinct from the brand gradient so "not shipped yet" never reads as "shipped."

Cards



Navigation patterns

COMPONENT	FILE	NOTES
Header	<code>Header.tsx</code>	Fixed top, <code>backdrop-blur</code> , <code>ScrollProgressBar</code> at its bottom edge
Floating bottom nav	<code>FloatingBottomNav.tsx</code>	Visible to all visitors (not just signed-in) — 5 of 6 tabs are free public content; last tab is "Profile" or "Sign In"
Search palette	<code>ui/command.tsx</code> + <code>SiteSearch.tsx</code>	Top-anchored (not centered), <code>rounded-2xl</code> on mobile, keyboard-hint footer on desktop
Theme toggle	<code>ThemeToggle.tsx</code>	Sun/Moon icon button; header (desktop) + mobile sheet header

Light / dark mode

- **Library:** next-themes (works fine outside Next.js — it's a framework-agnostic React context/hook).
- **Setup:** <ThemeProvider attribute="class" defaultTheme="system" enableSystem disableTransitionOnChange> wraps the whole app in App.tsx, outermost provider.
- **Default behaviour:** follows the visitor's OS/browser prefers-color-scheme automatically — no manual action needed.
- **Manual override:** ThemeToggle.tsx — a single Sun/Moon button using useTheme()'s resolvedTheme/setTheme. Once clicked, the explicit choice is stored in localStorage ("theme") and wins over the OS setting on future visits.
- **Tailwind wiring:** darkMode: ["class"] in tailwind.config.ts — the provider toggles a literal class="dark" on <html>, which activates the .dark { ... } variable block in index.css.

Motion conventions

PATTERN	DETAIL
Gradient border spin	5s linear infinite
Button hover	hover:scale-[1.02–1.05] active:scale-[0.98]
Card hover	hover:-translate-y-0.5 + shadow bump
Dialog/Sheet enter-exit	tailwindcss-animate's animate-in/animate-out (fade + zoom/slide)
Reduced motion	All of the above collapse to instant/no-op under prefers-reduced-motion: reduce (see the media query block at the end of index.css)

Layout constants

TOKEN	VALUE
Container max-width	1400px @2xl breakpoint, 2rem side padding, centered
Base radius unit	--radius: 0.5rem
Header height	h-16 (64px) mobile · h-20 (80px) desktop

Every value in this document was read directly from these files at generation time. If this document and the code ever disagree, **the code wins** — treat this as a snapshot, not the source of truth, and regenerate it after major design-system changes (see CLAUDE.md's "Site-wide design-system pass" entries for the running changelog of what changed and why).

TOPIC	FILE
Color tokens, gradient, shadows, base type rule	src/index.css
Tailwind theme mapping (colors/radius/shadow/fonts)	tailwind.config.ts
Theme provider setup	src/App.tsx
Theme toggle	src/components/ThemeToggle.tsx
Header nav, brand gradient badges, logo usage	src/components/Header.tsx
Scroll progress bar	src/components/ScrollProgressBar.tsx
Floating bottom nav	src/components/FloatingBottomNav.tsx
Search dialog	src/components/SiteSearch.tsx, src/components/ui/command.tsx
Button variants	src/components/ui/button.tsx
Card, Dialog, AlertDialog radii	src/components/ui/card.tsx, dialog.tsx, alert-dialog.tsx
SKYNN AI intro / gradient text / stepper / confidence ring	src/components/AIFormulator.tsx, src/components/ai-formulator/StepperHeader.tsx, ConfidencePanel.tsx
Homepage hero	src/components/Hero.tsx
Brand logo asset	src/assets/newskinlabs.png
Fonts (Google Fonts links)	index.html
Durable project memory / architecture decisions	CLAUDE.md

Generated by Claude for the SkinLabs engineering team and future AI coding assistants working on this repository. Not a legal brand-guidelines document — for that, a human should formalize clearspace, minimum sizing, and co-branding rules for the SkinLabs logo, which do not currently exist in code or elsewhere in this repo.

